



February 4, 2026

Doug La Fave
Deputy City Manager
City of East Grand Rapids
750 Lakeside Drive SE
East Grand Rapids, MI 49506

Re: East Grand Rapids High School Parking

Dear Mr. La Fave,

This letter is meant to address the previous memo submitted on 11/10/2025 regarding the East Grand Rapids High School Parking, specifically the loss of the senior parking lot on the north side of Lake Drive and how that will affect school traffic.

In that memo, several parking options were discussed and recommended with respect to the new high school expansion. After additional consultation with the City and schools, the schools review noted that some options and recommendations may not be feasible due to certain on-campus limitations and variables that are present. As the city and schools continue to evaluate potential parking options, on-campus and the surrounding external city road/pedestrian network factors should be evaluated related to vehicle, pedestrian, and mobility user impacts to ensure that the best solution is implemented.

Sincerely,

Joseph Eberle

Digitally signed by Joseph Eberle
DN: C=US,
E=j.eberle@weareprogressive.com,
O=Progressive AE, CN=Joseph
Eberle
Date: 2026.02.04 14:07:27-05'00'

Joseph P. Eberle, PE
Transportation Engineer

JPE/ecy

P:\77510008\03 WIP\C1 PRE DESIGN\School Parking Garage\2025 11 10 EGR High School Parking Memo.docx



November 10, 2025

Doug La Fave
City Deputy Manager
City of East Grand Rapids
750 Lakeside Drive SE
East Grand Rapids, MI 49506

Re: East Grand Rapids High School Parking

Dear Mr. La Fave,

This memorandum is meant to summarize Progressive Companies' observations and recommendations relating to the East Grand Rapids High School (High School) expansion, specifically the loss of the senior parking lot on the north side of Lake Drive and how that will affect school traffic.

The High School expansion project plans to expand the existing High School to the southeast, occupying the space currently used for the senior parking lot (Lot 15 on the attached parking map). This parking lot has 111 parking spaces and is primarily used by students, with some staff also using the lot. The proposed site plan provides accommodations for maintaining 40 of these spaces, resulting in a net loss of 71 parking spaces. Several concepts for how to replace these parking spaces have been explored, including further utilizing the existing on-street parking spaces near the High School, constructing a new surface parking lot as an addition to the existing East Grand Rapids Middle School (Middle School) parking lot southeast of the High School, or constructing a multi-level parking structure in the existing Lot 11 on the north side of the High School.

To evaluate each concept, Progressive Companies analyzed parking data provided by the City of East Grand Rapids (City), showing available parking spaces near the High School, parking utilization during the day, and concepts of the potential Middle School parking lot expansion and High School parking structure.

ON-STREET PARKING

Currently, some High School students utilize the on-street parking near the High School on residential streets from San Lu Rae Drive to Ogden Avenue. Parking survey data showed several parked cars on these streets near Lake Drive during school hours, with excess capacity on each street. A parking study conducted, specifically on these side streets between Lake Drive and Argentina Drive, showed an average capacity of 111 parking spaces and a minimum of 89 parking spaces during a school day.

These available parking spaces should provide a sufficient amount of parking to accommodate the 71 lost parking spaces in the senior parking lot. The potential drawbacks of utilizing these available on-street parking spaces includes requiring a longer walk to school for some students compared to parking in the senior parking lot and require students to cross Lake Drive. Additionally, some residents could have an issue with students parking on-street, however there are not any known complaints about the current students using this parking.

Currently, Lake Drive has several signed and marked crosswalks on each side street where students will park. This longer walk should encourage carpooling, walking, or biking to school, which could further decrease the parking demand for the High School. Using these parking spaces for students also utilizes these parking spaces during times when they are typically unoccupied and leaves them available when there is parking demand from residents and non-students. The peak utilization for students will be during school hours (7:00 a.m. to 2:30 p.m.) when the majority of residents are at work, not utilizing the on-street parking spaces. Then after 3:00 p.m., the majority of these parking spaces will re-open as students leave the school and they are available for residents returning home from work or other vehicles looking to park on street near Gaslight Village.

MIDDLE SCHOOL PARKING LOT EXPANSION

An expansion of the existing Middle School parking lot has also been proposed as a potential solution to losing the High School senior parking lot. This expansion is anticipated to add up to 103 parking spaces to the existing lot, taking the place of the existing tennis courts on the west side of the school. This parking expansion could replace most of the lost parking spaces in the senior parking lot and create a longer walk for students, approximately 1,000 feet from the parking lot to the school. This walk will be longer than some of the on-street parking available and shorter than the on-street parking spaces available near Argentina Drive. Students will need to cross Lakeside Drive, however, there is a signalized crosswalk at Lake Drive and a rectangular rapid flashing beacons (RRFB) mid-block crossing near the library. If this parking lot expansion is constructed, it is likely that some students will still choose to utilize the on-street parking near the high school since some of these spaces would be closer to the high school than the new parking lot.

Parking data provided by the City supports additional parking in this area. A clear pattern shows the existing parking lot full during school hours, emptying after school, and then filling to capacity again in the evening. This parking lot is utilized by both parents and residents attending sports events in the area as well as the community center and canoe/kayak launch. An expansion on this parking lot will likely be utilized by High School students and staff during the day and remain full during the evenings with parents and residents.

PARKING STRUCTURE

A two (2) to four (4) level parking structure has also been proposed in the current location of Lot 11 on the north side of the High School. This structure is proposed to have 136–291 parking spaces and will serve to replace the parking spaces in Lots 11 and 15. The structure would provide on-site parking for both students and staff and provide parking for Gaslight Village for after school hours. Students that park at this location will not be required to cross any streets, however, they may be required to walk around the High School to get to the new main entrance that will be constructed where Lot 15 is located (approximately 1,000 feet).

A drawback of a parking structure will be the load-in and load-out traffic patterns. By concentrating parking spaces to one (1) location with one (1) entrance/exit, Bagley Avenue will likely experience traffic backing up in the morning before school. Exiting traffic after school will be anticipated to cause less network traffic issues; however, load out of the structure is anticipated to take 30 minutes to one (1) hour depending on the size of the structure and number of vehicles parked, which significantly delays students and staff after school. These delays can result in less desire to park in the parking structure with students and staff instead choosing to utilize existing on-street parking that will provide faster parking options before and after school.

BUSSING PILOT

An alternative to constructing additional parking is providing bus service for students that live farther away from the high school. Currently, East Grand Rapids has elementary schools distributed across the city, allowing students to walk / bike to school easily. Since the middle school and high school are located centrally in the city, students that live towards the city limits of East Grand Rapids are less likely to walk or bike due to the increased distance. Providing a bus service with pick up and drop off locations at the existing elementary schools or city owned parks could provide several pick up / drop off locations throughout the city with locations that most students are already familiar with walking or biking to. This pilot program could be implemented during the high school construction and potentially be extended based on its popularity. This bus service could further reduce the need for onsite parking for students, specifically appealing to the students that do not want to walk or bike to school based on distance. Based on the program's popularity, bus shelters and bike racks could also be implemented at these pick up / drop off locations. An additional benefit of this pilot could be improving pick up and drop off queues and delays at the middle school and high school, since some students that are currently being dropped off may also choose to use the bus instead. A graphic showing bus pick up / drop off locations based on student populations is attached to this memo.

RECOMMENDATIONS

After reviewing these options under consideration for student and staff parking, Progressive Companies recommends constructing the High School expansion without any parking improvements. Several parking studies show that sufficient on-street parking exists within 1,500 feet of the High School and less accommodating parking will encourage more carpooling and walking/biking to school. The on-street parking also provides parking closest to the new main entrance to the High School and is likely to be utilized, regardless of any additional parking. Implementing the bussing pilot program could further reduce the need for onsite parking during construction, and could be implemented further based on popularity.

If parking problems occur after the school expansion is completed, such as complaints from nearby residents, consideration should be given to the Middle School parking lot expansion. This expansion can be sized more

appropriately based on the areas where parking problems occur and will provide additional parking at a less expensive price than a parking structure. Additionally, there is significant demand for parking in this location during and after school hours, so the additional parking is likely to be heavily utilized.

If the Middle School parking lot expansion is constructed and parking problems still occur, then further consideration can be given to a parking structure on campus. Due to the cost and complexity of operating a parking structure, this option should only be considered after other options have been explored.

Sincerely,

Joseph Eberle

Digitally signed by Joseph Eberle
DN: C=US,
E=j.eberle@weareprogressive.com,
O=Progressive AE, CN=Joseph Eberle
Date: 2025.11.10 15:51:51-05'00'

Joseph P. Eberle, PE
Transportation Engineer



GASLIGHT VILLAGE PARKING MAP CITY OF EAST GRAND RAPIDS MICHIGAN



0 0.0375 0.075 0.15 0.225 0.3 Miles

Date Updated 9/12/25

By: B. Bigorowski

OFF-STREET

- 1) School - Elementary School - 34 Spots*
- 2) Private - 21 Spots
- 3) Private - 28 Spots
- 4) Private - 18 Spots
- 5) Public - 2 Hr. Parking 6am-6pm - 21 spots
- 6) Private - 213 Spots
- 7) Public - WaterFront Park - 15 Spots
- 8) DPW Facility - 68 Spots
- 9) Private - 29 Spots
- 10) Private - Open to Public for \$ - 183 Spots
- 11) School - High School - 49 Spots*
- 12) Private - 28 Spots
- 13) School - High School - 29 Spots*
- 14) School - High School - 28 Spots*
- 15) School - High School - 111 Spots*
- 16) Private - GR Yacht Club - 35 Spots (Closed to non-members)
- 17) Public - Community Center - 100 Spots
- 18) School - Middle School - 63 Spots*
- 19) Private - 8 Spots
- 20) School - Elementary School - 50 Spots*
- 21) Private - 20 Spots

ON-STREET (ALL PUBLIC)

- A) Wealthy St. - 5 Spots east of Greenwood
 - a. North - No Parking
 - b. South - No Limits
- B) Greenwood Ave. - 24 Spots
 - a. West - No parking Nov. 1st to March 31st
 - b. East - No Limits
- C) Lovett Ave. - 13 Spots
 - a. West - No parking
 - b. South - No Limits
 - b. East - 2 Hr. Parking
- D) Lovett Ave. - 18 Spots
 - a. West - No parking
 - b. East - No Limits
- E) Crowwell Ave. - 13 Spots
 - a. West - No parking
 - b. East - No Limits
- F) Gaslight Village Marked Spots - 74 Spots
 - a. 2 Hr. Parking 6am-6pm
- G) Bagley Ave.
 - a. No Parking
- H) Lakeside Dr. (Reeds Lake Blvd to Wealthy St.) - 73 Spots
 - a. Mostly No Limits (some no parking)
- I) Lakeside Dr. (Wealthy St. to Lake Dr.) - 50 Spots
 - a. North - Mostly No Parking
 - b. South - No Limits
- J) Lake Dr. - 46 Spots
 - a. North - No Limits on most of street
 - b. South - No Parking
- K) San Luis Ave. - 15 Spots
 - a. North - No Limits
 - b. South - No Limits
- L) Shopping Center Road
 - a. West Side - No Parking 12am to 6am
 - b. East Side - No Parking
- M) Ogden - 19 Spots
 - a. West Side - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- N) Maxwell - 24 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- O) Lakeside - 20 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- P) Orchard - 23 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- Q) Pinecrest - 32 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- R) Floral - 30 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Parking
 - b. Eastside - No Limits
- S) San Jose - 22 Spots
 - a. Westside - No Limits
 - b. No Parking

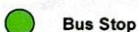
Bus Route Number 6 Runs In and Out of Gaslight Village
Parking Available Along the Route

<https://www.ridetherapid.org/ride/routes/6>

Legend

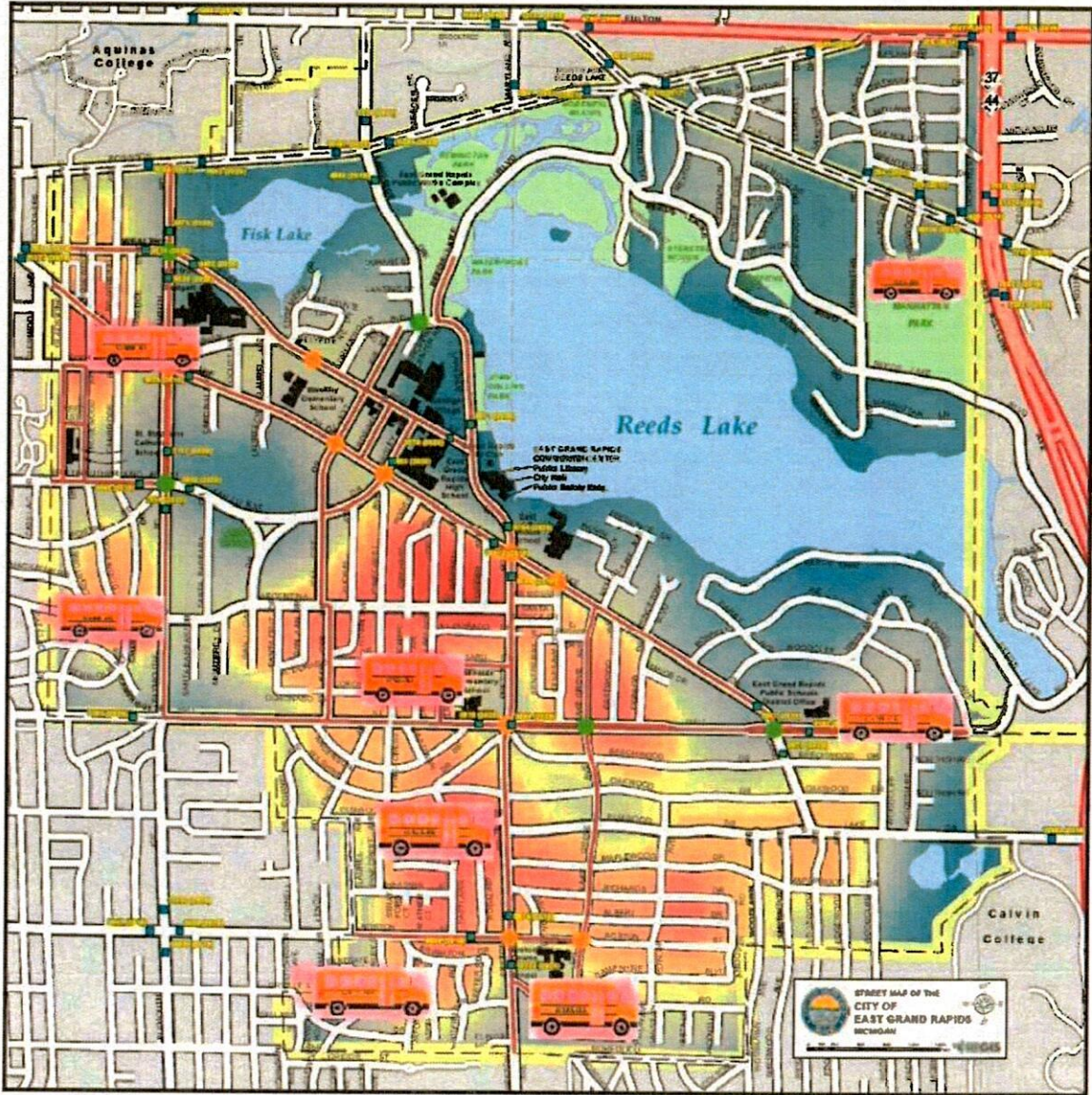
- Private
- Public
- School

*(School Lots Open After School Hours But
Not During School Events or Overnight)



Bus Stop

Alternative Transportation Hub Concept-Pilot



Daily Traffic Volumes

- Traffic Count within EGR (Year)
- Traffic Count outside EGR (Year)

Crossing Guard Locations

- Existing
- Proposed

Student Locations

- High
- Low

Sidewalk Plowing Priority